

2.1: Planning a Wireless Home Network

The Basics

Planning is the name of the game. Spend quality time planning for the best performance of the wireless network you intend to set up in your home.

Since we are talking about linking two or more PCs wirelessly, you will need to first make the list of the Wi-fi equipment that you will be needing.

Wireless hardware available in the market usually comes with documentation that explains in detail how to get it up and running. It will therefore help if certain issues are cleared beforehand. These issues will depend on what kind of systems you are going to connect. Is it going to be two PCs, a Mac and a PC, or is there a wireless printer involved as well?

What kind of speed you expect out of your wireless network? Are your data transfers going to involve accesses to files and folders, or are you planning to stream movies and music stored on one machine to the other? The amount of data transfer will play an important role in deciding what type (a, b or g) of Wireless LAN you will need for seamless data transfer.

You will also need to take into consideration how you will connect to the Net. Is it going to be a dial-up connection, a connection provided by the local cablewallah, or DSL? Also, how will you share the connection?



A WLAN Access Point